This is a traditional soup with a modern twist. Adding baking powder and mashed potato to the balls gives them a really light, fluffy texture.

matzo ball soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 1 HR 10 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
BROTH ONLY

1 chicken leg and thigh portion
1 onion, finely chopped
1 leek, thinly sliced
1 large carrot, finely diced
1 quart (1 liter) water
1 sprig of fresh thyme
1 tsp celery salt
salt and freshly ground black pepper

for the matzo balls
1 potato, about 4oz (115g), cooked and mashed
1½oz (45g) fine matzo meal
½ tsp baking powder
½ tsp grated fresh ginger
1 tbsp chopped fresh thyme
1 tbsp chopped fresh parsley
1 garlic clove, finely chopped
salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 tbsp sunflower oil
1 egg, beaten
4 small sprigs of fresh thyme, to garnish

1 Put the soup ingredients in a large saucepan. Bring to a boil, reduce the heat, cover, and simmer gently for 1 hour, adding more water if it gets low. Meanwhile, mix the mashed potatoes with the matzo meal, baking powder, ginger, thyme, parsley, garlic, and a little salt and pepper. Add the oil, then mix with the beaten egg to form a soft, slightly sticky dough. Shape into 8 balls.

2 Discard the thyme sprig from the soup. Carefully lift out the chicken and remove all meat from the bones, discarding the skin. Chop the meat and return to the soup. Taste and adjust the seasoning, if necessary.

3 Bring the soup back to a simmer, drop in the balls, cover, and simmer gently for about 10 minutes until fluffy and cooked through. Ladle into warm soup bowls and garnish each with a small sprig of fresh thyme.